# Mental Health and Mental Illness

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# objectives

***At the end of this lecture, each student should be able to:***

- Discuss the parameters of mental health and mental illness through:
- Define the mental health and mental illness .
- Describe the component of mental health.
- Identify Factors influencing mental health.
- Differentiate between the general characteristics of mental health and mental illness.
- Practices that decrease the mental health.
- Practices that increase the mental health .
- Diagnostic and statistical manual of mental disorders (DSM-IV-TR)..
- Psychiatric–mental health nursing: scope and standards of practice

# Definition of mental health

**The World Health Organization (WHO)** defines health as "a state of complete physical, mental, and social well-being, not merely the absence of disease or infirmity".

**M.H** is a state of emotional, psychological and social wellness evidenced by satisfying interpersonal relationships, effective behavior and coping, a positive self- concept and emotional stability.

# Components of mental health

1) ***Self-governance:*** The person demonstrates autonomy.
2) ***Growth orientation:*** progress toward self-realization, maximization of capacities.
3) ***Tolerance of uncertainty:*** The person faces the uncertainty of living
4) ***Self-esteem:*** built on self-knowledge and awareness of talents, abilities, and limitations.
5) ***Mastery of the environment:***, capable, competent, and creative in dealing with and influencing the environment.
6) ***Reality orientation:*** distinguishes
7) ***Stress management:*** experiences

# Three Factors influencing mental health

1. **Inherited characteristics.**
2. **Nurturing during childhood.**
3. **Life circumstances:** include success in school, financial security, good physical health or a successful marriage.

# General characteristics of mentally health individual

***Mentally healthy is***

- Able to work well alone and with others.
- Accepts responsibility for his actions.
- Is able to give and receive.
- Is optimistic.
- Is able to express feelings.
- Is able to solve problems.
- Is able to benefit from rest and sleep.
- Can recognize limitations (abilities and deficiencies).

## *Mentally healthy is*

- Is able to form meaning full relationships.
- Is able to make sound judgments and decisions.
- Can take care of his hygiene and clothes in a manner, which conforms to the standards of his society.
- Is able to cope success fully with stress, that is mean, a person can return t normal functioning if temporarily disturbed.
- Is able to distinguish fact from fantasy or the real world from a dream

# Mental Illness

The American Psychiatric Association (A.P.A) defines the mental disorder as a clinically significant behavioral or psychological syndrome or pattern that occurs in an individual and that is associated with present distress (e.g., a painful symptoms) or disability (i.e. impairment in one or more important areas of functioning) or with a significantly increased risk of suffering death, pain, disability or important loss of freedom.

Or

- **Mental disorders** are health conditions characterized by alterations in thinking, mood, or behavior. They are associated with distress or impaired functioning.

# General criteria and characteristics to diagnose individuals with mental disorders include:-

1) When an individual is not able to view himself clearly, feels inadequacy or has a distorted view of self, has poor self- concept and dissatisfaction with one's characteristics, abilities and accomplishment.
2) Is unable to maintain satisfying personal relationships and unable to cope and exhibits maladaptive behavior and dissatisfied with one's place in the world.
3) Displays poor judgment
4) Ineffective coping with life events
5) Lack of personal growth

6) unable to accept responsibility for action

7) Is pessimistic

8) Does not recognize limitations (abilities and deficiencies)

9) Exhibits dependency needs because of feelings of inadequacy.

10) Is unable to perceive reality

11) Does not recognize potential and talents because of poor-self-concept.

12) Avoid problems rather than coping with them.

13) When his behavior is deviated sufficiently from normal to indicate disorganization of the self and we consider this person is mentally ill.

# Possible signs of mental illness

- Marked personality changed over times
- Confused thinking, as grandiose ideas
- Prolonged severe depression and apathy
- Excessive anxiety, fear or suspiciousness, blaming others
- Withdrawal from society, friendlessness, abnormal self center
- Thinking or talking about suicide
- Denial of obvious problems, strong resistance to help
- Numerous, unexplained physical ailments

- Marked changes in eating or sleeping patterns
- Anger or hostility out of proportion to the situation
- Delusions (false beliefs that are firmly maintained even though they are not shared by others)
- Abuse of alcohols or drugs
- Hallucination (perceptual distortions, arising from any of the senses, hearing voices, or seeing images that others don't hear or see)
- Growing inability to cope with problems and the daily activities as school, jobs or personal needs.

# Practices that decrease the mental health are:

- Over eating, eating cooked food,
- Improper food eating cause depression, anger, fear, instability anxiety and other forms of emotional dysfunction. The brain and body are nutritionally interrelated and interdependent.
- Deficiencies of vitamin B1, B3, B6 and C, calcium and magnesium cause mental illness.
- Mental illness can be caused by chemical imbalances in brain, by the transfer of drugs across placental barrier or by organic changes with in the brain. If the person is unsuccessful in dealing with environmental stresses, poor nurturing during childhood or negative life circumstances.

# Practices that increase mental health

- Fasting and eating sparingly, eating raw fruits and vegetable diet (fasts and/or eat a proper diet will not have any negative emotions)
- Obtaining sufficient sleep, meditation, being aware, vigorous exercise, receiving adequate sunshine, in taking fresh air, being free of toxins, daily mental exercises, self-confidence and self-mastery.
- If you are nervous, depressed, phobic, neurotic or psychotic, to feel better and to get well, close your eyes and keep them closed every moment you can. Closing the eyes rests the brain and mind.
- Taking moderate physical activities and exercises (nervous energy is used up by physical activities)
- No body can make you mentally ill with their verbal abuse to you. No one can take advantage of you without your permission. Nothing can bother you unless you let it.
- Self-control is the great law of mental health.

# DIAGNOSTIC AND STATISTICAL MANUAL OF MENTAL DISORDERS (DSM-IV-TR)

- **Axis I** is for identifying all major psychiatric disorders except mental retardation and personality disorders. Examples include depression, schizophrenia, anxiety, and substance-related disorders.

- • **Axis II** is for reporting mental retardation and personality disorders as well as prominent maladaptive personality features and defense mechanisms.

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- **Axis III** is for reporting current medical conditions that are potentially relevant to understanding or managing the person's mental disorder as well as medical conditions that might contribute to understanding the person. As Diabetes Mellitus.

- **Axis IV** is for reporting psychosocial and environmental problems that may affect the diagnosis, treatment, and prognosis of mental disorders. Included are problems with primary support group, social environment, education, occupation, housing, economics, access to health care, and legal system.

- **Axis V** presents a Global Assessment of Functioning (GAF), which rates the person's overall psychological functioning on a scale of 0 to 100. This represents the clinician's assessment of the person's current level of functioning; the clinician also may give a score for prior functioning (for instance, highest GAF in past year or GAF 6 months ago).

# Psychiatric-Mental Health Nursing

Psychiatric-mental health nursing is an integral part of the continuum of nursing practice. The American nurse association (A.N.A) describes Psychiatric-mental health nursing as "a specialized area of nursing practice that employs theories of human behavior as its science and the purposeful use of self as its art. It is the diagnoses and treatment of human responses to actual or potential mental disorders and their long-term effects. Intervention include the continues and comprehensive primary health care services necessary for the promotion of optimal health, the prevention of mental illness, rehabilitation from mental-disorders, and health maintenance.

# PSYCHIATRIC–MENTAL HEALTH NURSING SCOPE AND STANDARDS OF PRACTICE

## I- STANDARDS OF PRACTICE

- **Standard 1. Assessment**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse collects comprehensive health data that is pertinent to the patient's health of situation.
- **Standard 2. Diagnosis**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse analyzes the assessment data to determine diagnoses of problems, including level of risk
- **Standard 3. Outcomes Identification**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse identifies expected outcomes for a plan individualized to the patient or the situation.

- **Standard 4. Planning**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse develops a plan that prescribes strategies and alternatives to attain expected outcomes.
- **Standard 5. Implementation 7**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse implements the identified plan.
- **Standard 5A. Coordination of Care**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse coordinates care delivery.
- **Standard 5B. Health Teaching and Health Promotion**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse employs strategies to promote health and a safe environment.
- **Standard 5C. Milieu Therapy**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse provides, structures, and maintains a safe and therapeutic environment in collaboration with patients, families, and other health-care clinicians.

- **Standard 5D. Pharmacological, Biological, and Integrative Therapies**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse incorporates knowledge of pharmacological, biologic, and complementary interventions with applied clinical skills to restore the patient's health and prevent further disability.
- **Standard 5E. Prescriptive Authority and Treatment**
- The psychiatric–mental health advanced practice registered nurse uses prescriptive authority, procedures, referrals, treatments, and therapies in accordance with state and federal laws and regulations.

- **Standard 5F. Psychotherapy**
- The psychiatric–mental health advanced practice registered nurse conducts individual, couple, group, and family psychotherapy using evidence-based psychotherapeutic frameworks and nurse–patient therapeutic relationships.
- **Standard 5G. Consultation**
- The psychiatric–mental health advanced practice registered nurse provides consultation to influence the identified plan, enhance the abilities of other clinicians to provide services for patients, and effect change.
- (*Note:* Standards 5D–G are advanced practice interventions

and may be performed only by the psychiatric–mental health advanced practice registered nurse.)

- **Standard 6. Evaluation**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse evaluates progress toward attainment of expected outcomes.

# II- STANDARDS OF PROFESSIONAL PERFORMANCE

- **Standard 7. Quality of Practice**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse systematically enhances the quality and effectiveness of nursing practice.
- **Standard 8. Education**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse attains knowledge and competency that reflect current nursing practice.
- **Standard 9. Professional Practice Evaluation**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse evaluates one's own practice in relation to the professional practice standards and guidelines, relevant statues, rules, and regulations.
- **Standard 10. Collegiality**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse interacts with and contributes to the professional development of peers and colleagues.

- **Standard 11. Collaboration**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse collaborates with patients, family, and others in the conduct of nursing practice.
- **Standard 12. Ethics**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse integrates ethical provisions in all areas of practice.
- **Standard 13. Research**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse integrates research findings into practice.
- **Standard 14. Resource Utilization**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse considers factors related to safety, effectiveness, cost, and impact on practice in the planning and delivery of nursing services.
- **Standard 15. Leadership**
- The psychiatric–mental health registered nurse provides leadership in the professional practice setting and the profession.

# *Critical Thinking Questions*

- 1. In your own words, describe mental health. Describe the characteristics, behavior, and abilities of someone who is mentally healthy.
- 2. What personal characteristics do you have that indicate good mental health?
- FILL-IN-THE-BLANK QUESTIONs
  - *Indicate what type of information is recorded for each axis of the DSM-IV.*
  - _____ Axis I
  - _____ Axis II
  - _____ Axis III
  - _____ Axis IV
  - _____ Axis V

# Thank You